

SENATE No. 2706

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

SENATE, November 19, 2025.

The committee on Consumer Protection and Professional Licensure to whom was referred the petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 283) of Pavel M. Payano, Joan B. Lovely, Jason M. Lewis, Brendan P. Crighton and other members of the Senate for legislation to expand licensure opportunity for school counselors, report the accompanying bill (Senate, No. 2706).

For the committee,
Pavel M. Payano

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An Act expanding licensure opportunity for school counselors..

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. The first paragraph of section 165 of chapter 112 of the General Laws, as
2 appearing in the 2022 Official Edition, is hereby amended by striking out clause (3) and inserting
3 in place thereof the following clause:-

4 (3) demonstrates to the board, the successful completion of a masters degree in a
5 relevant field from an educational institution licensed by the state in which it is located and
6 meets national standards for granting of a masters degree with a subspecialization in marriage
7 and family therapy, rehabilitation counseling, counseling, or a relevant subspecialization
8 approved by the board; provided, however, that all relevant graduate coursework credits, as
9 determined by the board, that an individual earns that count towards the credit requirement for
10 professional licensure as specialized instructional support personnel, which is inclusive of school
11 counselors, school social workers, adjustment counselors, and school psychologists, by the
12 department of elementary and secondary education shall be applied towards this educational
13 requirement for applicants seeking licensure as a mental health counselor, including credits
14 earned in a graduate program that is less than 60 credits. To be eligible for licensure, an applicant

15 must have 2 additional years of supervised clinical experience in the relevant field in: (i) either a
16 clinic or hospital licensed by the department of mental health or accredited by the Joint
17 Commission on Accreditation of Hospitals or in an equivalent center or institute; (ii) in a school
18 setting as a specialized instructional support personnel licensed by the department of elementary
19 and secondary education; or (iii) under the direction of a supervisor approved by the board.
20 Provided further, that any applicant seeking licensure as a mental health counselor who applies
21 graduate coursework or clinical experience as specialized instructional support personnel
22 licensed by the department of elementary and secondary education shall also demonstrate
23 completion of evidence-based training in suicide prevention or intervention. Such training may
24 be completed as part of a graduate program, professional development, or continuing education
25 approved by the board. For purposes of this clause, "Supervision" shall be defined as no less than
26 200 hours of supervised clinical experience, including experience as a specialized instructional
27 support personnel licensed by the department of elementary and secondary education, at least
28 100 hours of which shall consist of individual supervision with a clinician who has expertise in
29 marriage and family therapy, rehabilitation counseling, school counseling, educational
30 psychology, social work, or counseling and who holds a masters degree in social work, marriage
31 and family therapy, rehabilitation counseling, educational psychology, counseling or an
32 equivalent field or holds a doctorate degree in psychology, or a medical degree with a
33 subspecialization in psychiatry; provided, however, that experience as specialized instructional
34 support personnel shall only apply towards the supervised experience requirement for applicants
35 who are seeking licensure as a mental health counselor;

36 SECTION 2. Said section 165 of said chapter 112, as so appearing, is hereby further
37 amended by inserting after the word "section", in line 30, the following words:- provided,

38 however, that a school counselor shall be qualified to sit for the written or oral examination for
39 licensure as a mental health counselor.